

Safeguarding policy for children and vulnerable adults

Rules for working with children and vulnerable adults: pre-employment screening, no unjustified one-to-one work, and the incident response procedure.

1. Purpose

This policy sets out the measures protecting children and vulnerable adults from harm, including harm caused by the foundation's own personnel or by the way its work is organised.

2. Scope

All of the foundation's programmes, not only those that work directly with children.

3. Pre-appointment checks

- reference checks with previous employers — mandatory, and not a formality;
- a declaration of no restriction on working with children;
- mandatory training before starting work for everyone who will be on site with children.

4. The two-adult rule

No activity or conversation alone with a child takes place without a documented reason. The exception is an individual psychological consultation, which is held in a room with a glazed or open door, or with the parent's agreement, and is recorded in the register.

5. Responding to an incident

1. Securing the immediate safety of the child or vulnerable adult.
2. Notifying the safeguarding focal point within 24 hours.
3. Assessing whether guardianship authorities, the police or the children's service must be informed.
4. Suspending the member of staff for the duration of the investigation where there is a risk of recurrence.

6. Images and stories

Photographs of children are published only with the written consent of a parent or guardian, and without details that could identify the child. A beneficiary's story is published only after the text has been agreed with them.

7. Review

Annually and after every incident.

Draft document, pending the foundation's signature. Before any public use it is replaced by the current signed version approved by the foundation.